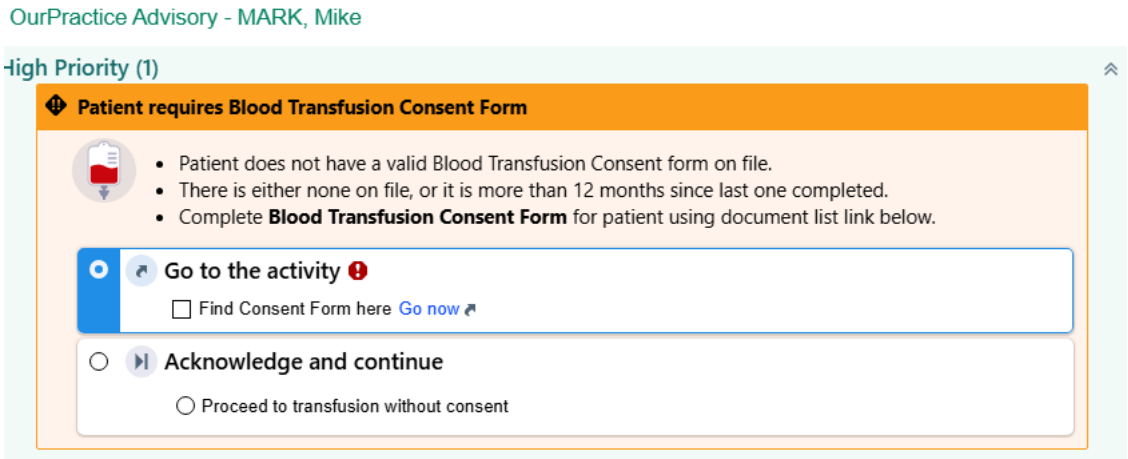
Consenting for blood transfusion in EPIC – tip sheet

Consent for transfusion must be documented within EPIC. Once completed the consent is valid for 12 months unless revoked by the patient. If there is no valid consent on record EPIC will fire an OPA for consent to be completed.

If it is necessary to bypass consent, for example in an emergency haemorrhage, the patient must be made aware of the transfusion at the earliest opportunity and this must be documented in the patient chart.

Documenting consent

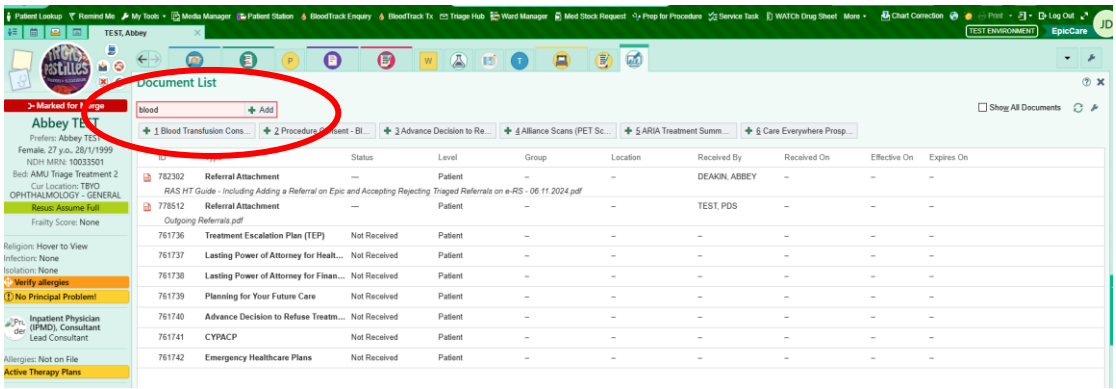
When you place an order for a blood component in the blood order set, if the patient does not have a valid consent form for transfusion (completed within the last 12 months), EPIC will fire an OPA for a consent form to be completed



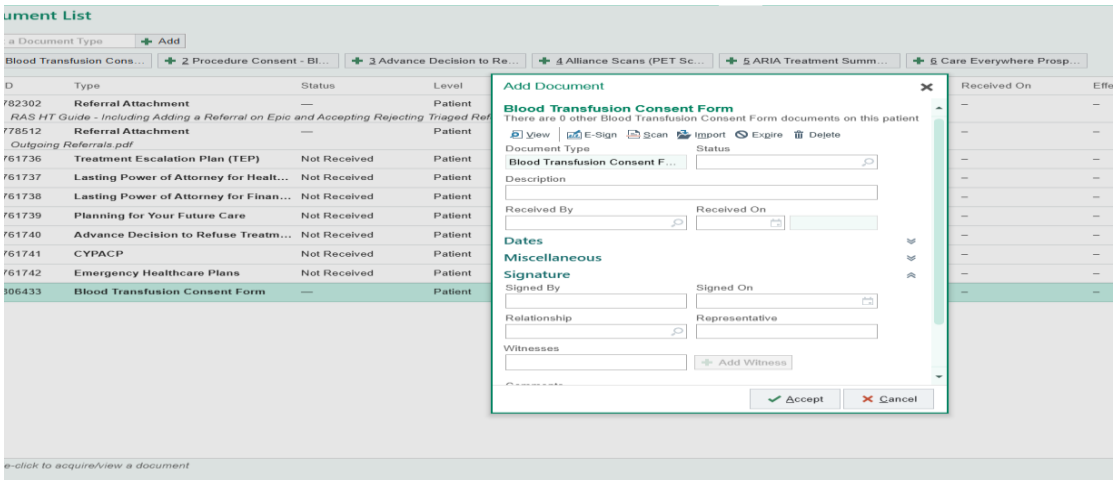
If the patient has other OPAs (as in the example above) they will all display together. Note: some OPAs will need to be completed before you can access the consent form.

Press the Go now to proceed to the next step.

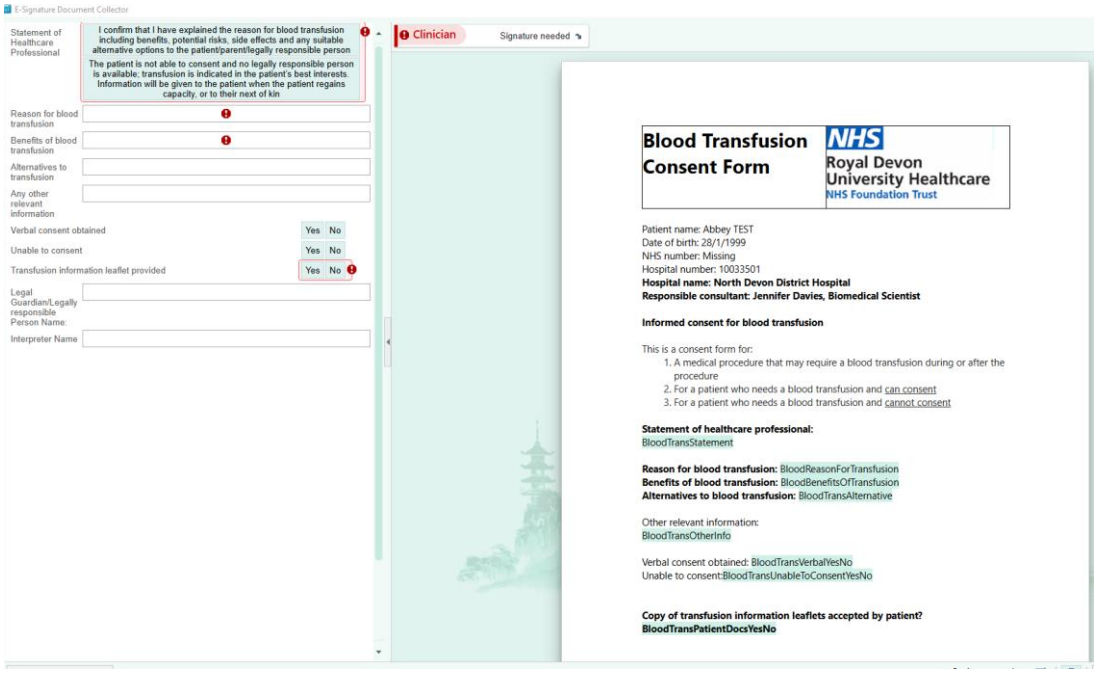
You will be taken to the document list. If the patient has never had a transfusion consent completed you will need to find the form by typing 'blood' in the search field.



Select the Blood Transfusion Consent Form option, this will open up a pop-up to add the consent form to the Document List. You will not have to search for the consent form every time, once you have used it EPIC will then populate on the list of favourites.

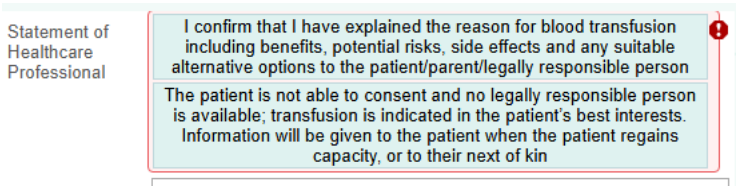


Select E-Sign to continue, this will open up the e-signature form



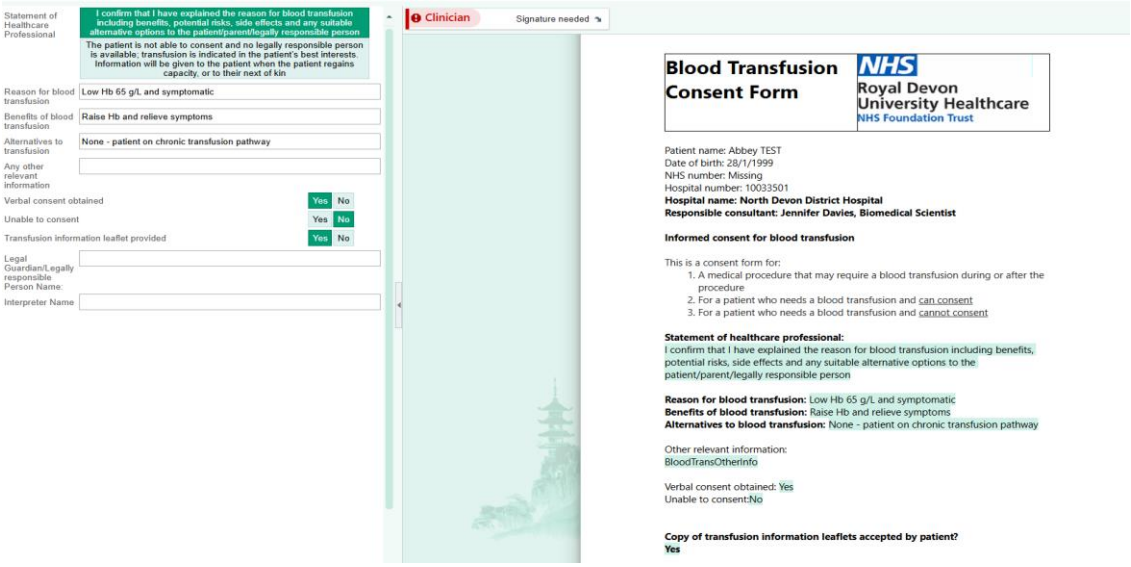
The statements to populate the form are on the left-hand side of the screen. Mandatory questions have red exclamation marks but for good practice all fields should be completed.

As the statements are completed the form will automatically populate with the information. Ensure that you select the correct statement relating to whether consent is possible or not



Further information about transfusion risks can be found in the [Transfusion Policies, guidelines and documents] page on HUB.

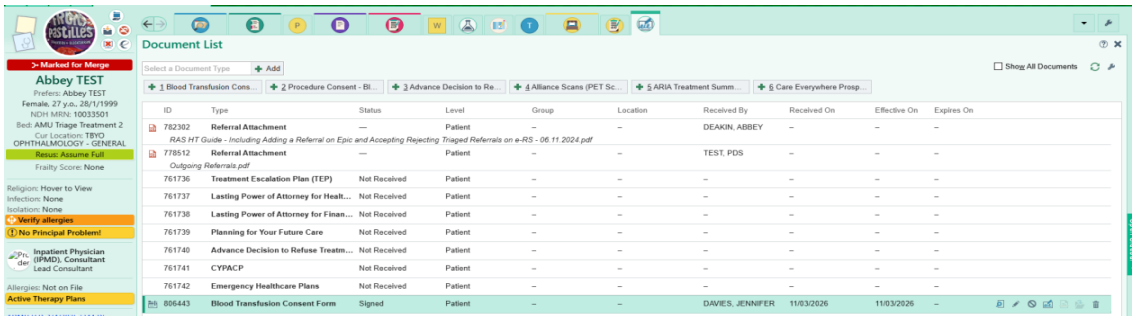
Once the relevant information has been entered this will appear in the consent form (right hand side below)



The form automatically adds the date of completion and provides fields for the e-signatures for the clinician and the patient.

Fields are also available for e-signatures for consenting persons, legal guardians, legally responsible persons and interpreters if applicable. Consent can be signed on the WOW (using mouse) or iPads.

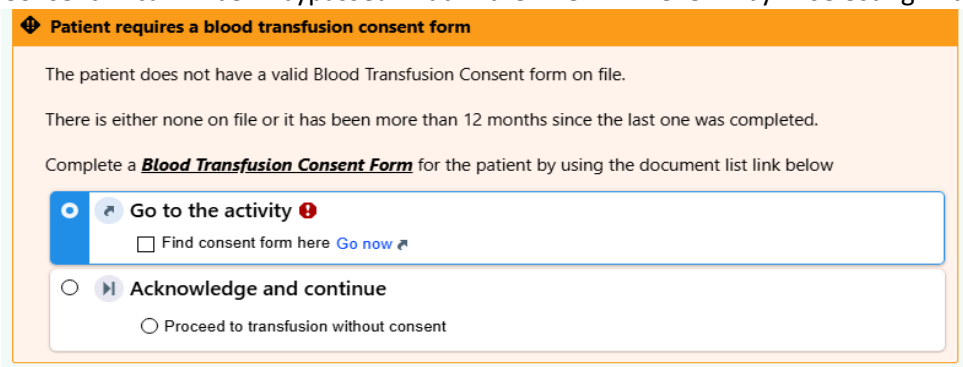
When the form is completed click 'Accept' to add the form to the documents list.



The order for blood components will then release and can be completed.

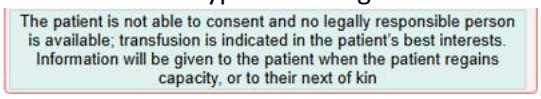
Bypassing consent

1. Consent can be bypassed at the OPA level by selecting this option



If this option is selected you will be able to proceed directly to the blood component orders. However, this will not make any record on EPIC regarding justification for not consenting the patient.

2. Consent can be bypassed using the consent form by selecting this option



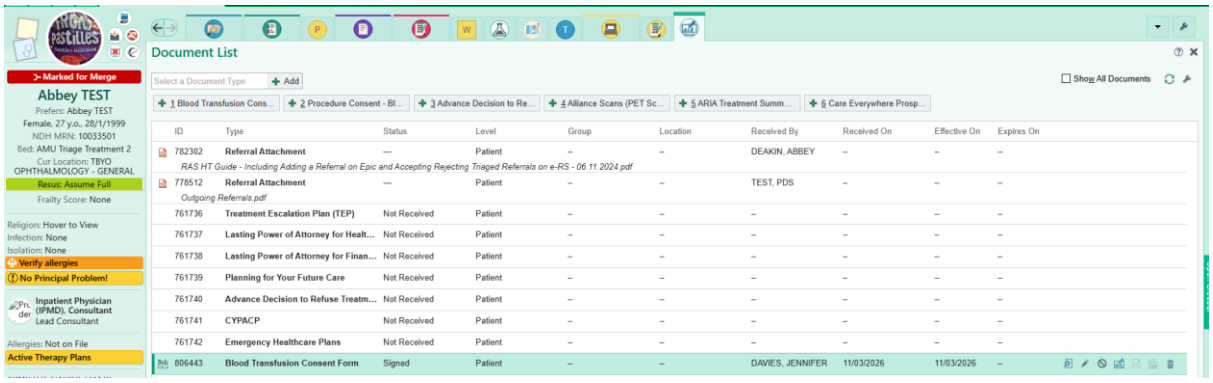
This indicates that due diligence has been followed and it was not possible to consent at the time for the transfusion. However, if this option is selected the consent OPA will not fire again for the patient until 12 months has elapsed.

Revoking consent

Consent can be revoked at any time by the patient. There is no form to complete in EPIC, the current consent form in EPIC must be deleted in the document list. Record the decision and discussion with the patient in the EPIC notes.

If the patient refuses transfusion of blood components or products, complete a blood refusal form in EPIC (see tip sheet 'Adding a blood refusal form to a patient record in EPIC- tip sheet' on the transfusion page in HUB).

To expire a consent from the patient record go to the Document List in EPIC



Use the edit icon to edit the form. Click on the Expire icon Expire to expire the record. This will then display on the document list.

1 Blood Transfusion Cons... | 2 Procedure Consent - Bl... | 3 Advance Decision to Re... | 4 Alliance Scans (PET Sc... | 5 ARIA Treatment Summ... | 6 Care Everywhere Prosp...

ID	Type	Status	Level	Group	Location	Received By	Received On	Effective On	Expires On
786563	Treatment Escalation Plan (TEP)	Not Received	Patient	–	–	–	–	–	–
786564	Lasting Power of Attorney for Healt...	Not Received	Patient	–	–	–	–	–	–
786565	Lasting Power of Attorney for Finan...	Not Received	Patient	–	–	–	–	–	–
786566	Planning for Your Future Care	Not Received	Patient	–	–	–	–	–	–
786567	Advance Decision to Refuse Treatm...	Not Received	Patient	–	–	–	–	–	–
786568	CYPACP	Not Received	Patient	–	–	–	–	–	–
786569	Emergency Healthcare Plans	Not Received	Patient	–	–	–	–	–	–
806732	Blood Transfusion Consent Form	Signed	Patient	–	–	DAVIES, JENNIFER	13/03/2026	13/03/2026	13/03/2026

The consent form will fire another OPA if a blood order is made at a later date. This will create a new consent form for the patient but the previous, expired consent form will still be visible on the document list.

References

Patient consent and shared decision-making for blood transfusion: guidelines from the SaBTO expert advisory committee 27 November 2025. https://www.gov.uk/government/publications/blood-transfusion-patient-consent/guidelines-from-the-expert-advisory-committee-on-the-safety-of-blood-tissues-and-organs-sabto-on-patient-consent-for-blood-transfusion